Travis (Xiaoyu) Zhao, CFA

CONTACT INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

Finance — **University of Massachusetts Amherst**
Ph.D. — 2021–2027 (expected)

Finance — **Hong Kong Polytechnic University**
M.Fin (with Distinction) — 2018

Economics — **Nankai University**
B.A. — 2012

RESEARCH INTEREST

Hedge Funds, Institutional Investors, Disclosures, Geopolitical Risk, Options, Cybersecurity

WORKING PAPERS

Who Signs Matters? Compliance Titles and Hedge Fund Disclosures (Job Market Paper)

Abstract: Hedge funds have incentives to conceal portfolio positions and may strategically misreport their holdings in mandatory public disclosures. We use Form 13F signature blocks to identify the personnel assigned formal reporting responsibility, distinguishing dedicated compliance titles from titles that include investment management or other functions. Filings signed by dedicated compliance personnel are less likely to be amended subsequently than those signed by executive or investment-leadership personnel, with the association concentrated in delayed restatements rather than prompt corrections or amendments adding previously undisclosed holdings. The delayed-restatement association persists after accounting for original-filing discrepancies and reported verification arrangements. Following a restatement's public release, abnormal stock returns are more closely aligned with the direction of reported position revisions when dedicated compliance personnel signed the original filing than under other signing roles. These findings highlight the allocation of formal reporting responsibility as an observable dimension of hedge fund governance, associated with both subsequent amendments and the market response to restatements.

Hedge Fund Performance and the U.S.–China Tension (with Bing Liang)

Presentations: *SoFiE Annual Conference 2026, Frontiers of Factor Investing Conference 2026 (Lancaster), EasternFA Annual Conference 2026, SWFA Annual Conference 2026, SHKDI Conference 2026 (CUHK), IFMB Conference 2026 (Nottingham Trent), Volatility Institute Conference 2025 (NYU-Shanghai), Boca Finance and Real Estate Conference 2025 (FAU)*

Informed Option Trading: Evidence from Data Breaches(solo-authored)

Presentations: *World Finance & Banking Symposium 2025, INFORMS Annual Meeting 2025, UMass Amherst Isenberg Brownbag (2024)*

WORK IN PROGRESS

Institutional Investor and Section-301 Tariffs
PCAOB and US-listed Chinese Stocks

Teaching

Instructor, Isenberg School of Management 2023–2026
Financial Modeling (FIN304)
Fall 2023 (4.7/5.0), Spring 2024 (4.8/5.0), Spring 2025 (4.5/5.0)
Fall 2025 (Online, 5.0/5.0)

International Finance (FIN405)
Fall 2024 (4.7/5.0)

Fundamentals of Finance (FIN301)
Fall 2026 (ongoing)

Substitute Instructor, Isenberg School of Management 2026
Topics in Financial Technology (FIN408)
Financial Engineering (FIN422)

Teaching Assistant, Isenberg School of Management 2021–2023
(for Prof. Wenting Ma)
Advanced Corporate Finance *(Fall 2021, Fall 2022, Fall 2023)*
Corporate Finance *(Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023)*
Fundamental Principles of Financial Management *(Spring 2023)*

Conferences

SoFiE Annual Conference† 2026
5th Frontiers of Factor Investing Conference (Lancaster)† 2026
EasternFA Annual Conference†‡ 2026
SWFA Annual Conference†‡ 2026
20th SHKDI Conference (CUHK)† 2026
4th IFMB Conference (Nottingham Trent)†‡ 2026
14th World Finance & Banking Symposium† 2025
10th Annual Volatility Institute Conference (NYU-Shanghai)† 2025
2nd Annual Boca Finance and Real Estate Conference (FAU)†‡ 2025
INFORMS Annual Meeting† 2025
FMA Annual Meeting‡ 2025
(*presenting* †, *discussant* ‡, *scheduled* *)

Awards and Honors

UMass Amherst GSG Research & Travel Grant 2026
Isenberg School of Management Doctorate Fellowship 2021–2026
Isenberg School of Management PhD Program Travel Grant 2025–2026
Isenberg School of Management Dissertation Proposal Fellowship 2025
Outstanding Academic Achievement Award, Hong Kong PolyU 2018

Memberships

Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA®) Charterholder
American Finance Association (AFA)
Financial Management Association (FMA)
Eastern Finance Association (EFA)

Non-academic Experience

China Financial Services Holdings Limited	*Investment Manager*	Sep 2018–May 2021, *Hong Kong*
Bank of Beijing Group	*Financing Manager*	Jun 2016–May 2017, *Beijing*
Xiamen International Bank	*Account Manager (Financial Institutions)*	Jul 2012–May 2016, *Beijing*

Skills

R, Stata, SAS (SQL), Python, WRDS, LaTeX

Languages

English (Fluent); Mandarin (Native); Cantonese (Fluent)

References

Prof. Bing Liang
(Committee co-chair)
Charles P. McQuaid Endowed-Professor of Finance
Finance Department
Isenberg School of Management
University of Massachusetts Amherst
bliang@isenberg.umass.edu

Prof. Marco Macchiavelli
(Committee co-chair)
Assistant Professor of Finance; PhD Co-Coordinator
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Prof. John Spraggon
(Committee Member)
Department of Resource Economics
College of Social & Behavioral Sciences
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Prof. Wenting Ma
Assistant Professor of Finance
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